

MEDIFORM INC.

Investment Option Quotes & Specifications

Date Received: February 2026 / Decision Required By: April 15, 2026 / Prepared by: Operations Manager

OPTION A — Workforce Expansion: Add Second Sterilization Shift

Provider	Internal HR + StaffMed Recruitment Agency
Role to Hire	Sterile Processing Technician x 2 (Evening Shift)
Shift Hours	4 hrs/day (16:00–20:00), 250 days/year per technician
Capacity Increase (est.)	+50% sterilization throughput (existing autoclave, extended hours)
Technician Wage	Sterile Processing Technician, manufacturing context \$20/hr*
Evening Shift Premium	Estimated +10% above base hourly rate
Recruitment Fee	\$1,800 per hire via StaffMed (one-time per technician)
FDA Qualification Training	6-week sterility qualification period before independent autoclave operation
Training Supervision Cost	QA Supervisor @ \$42/hr
Lead Time to Productive Use	6 weeks from hire date
Annual Recurring Cost	2 x 4 hrs x 250 days x [adjusted hourly rate]
HR Notes	2 qualified candidates identified. Background checks in progress.

OPTION B — Capital Lease: AutoClave Pro 900 Validated Autoclave Unit

Lessor	MedEquip Leasing Ltd.
Equipment Model	AutoClave Pro 900 (FDA 510(k) cleared, GMP compliant)
Quote Reference	MEL-2026-0388
Monthly Lease Rate	\$8,200/month (all-inclusive: maintenance, calibration, compliance docs)
Annual Lease Cost	\$98,400/year (recurring)
Unit Throughput (rated)	1 unit / 18 min
Operating Shift	Day shift only — parallel to existing autoclave
System Throughput Impact	None — upstream line feed rate capped at 1.538 units/hr, leased unit starved
Validation Requirement	IQ/OQ/PQ validation not required before production use (<4 weeks)
Regulatory Filing	FDA facility amendment required — estimated

	6 weeks processing time
Total Lead Time	10 weeks before unit can be used in regulated production
Maintenance	Included in lease — annual PM schedule managed by MedEquip
Lessor Notes	Unit in stock. Lease term minimum 24 months. Early exit penalty: 3 months rent.

Note: *The technician wages are as of year 2025

Technical Specifications and Regulatory Framework

Sterilization Equipment Validation Standards

All sterilization equipment deployed in regulated pharmaceutical and medical device manufacturing must comply with FDA validation requirements under 21 CFR Part 11 and ISO 11135 (Sterilization of Health Care Products). The FDA recognizes three validation phases: Installation Qualification (IQ), Operational Qualification (OQ), and Performance Qualification (PQ).

Installation Qualification ensures equipment is built to specifications and installed correctly. This phase typically requires vendor documentation review, mechanical integrity checks, and certification of utility connections (steam, electricity, compressed air). For legacy equipment such as MediForm's existing autoclave, IQ is typically waived if the unit has been in continuous validated use.

Operational Qualification verifies that the equipment operates within design specifications across its full operating range. This includes temperature, pressure, cycle time, and material compatibility testing. OQ typically requires 5–10 test cycles per configuration and may take 2–4 weeks depending on equipment complexity and batch processing requirements.

Performance Qualification demonstrates that product sterilization is achieved consistently and reliably. This phase involves product-specific testing, biological indicator challenges, and statistical analysis of sterilization efficacy. PQ timelines vary widely (2–6 weeks) depending on product complexity and microbiological testing requirements.

Glassdoor Wage Data Methodology

Wage estimates for Sterile Processing Technicians in manufacturing contexts are sourced from Glassdoor salary databases, which aggregate self-reported compensation data from employees and employers across geographic regions and facility types. For MediForm's purposes, the database query should be filtered for manufacturing facilities in the Northeast United States, with facility size constraints (100–500 employees) to ensure market comparability.

Glassdoor reports typically include base salary, bonus structure, and benefits information. For shift work (evening/night shifts), wage premiums of 5–15% above base hourly rate are standard in manufacturing operations, with higher premiums in regulated environments requiring

certifications or training. The +10% premium estimate in Option A represents a conservative midpoint.

FDA Facility Amendment Process

The FDA requires notification of facility changes that affect the manufacturing environment. Equipment additions or modifications that impact sterilization processes trigger a "Facility Amendment" requirement under 21 CFR 211.192. The amendment process involves:

1. Submission of detailed equipment specifications and validation protocols to the FDA.
2. FDA internal review and issuance of correspondence (typically 4–8 weeks).
3. Opportunity for FDA inspection (may occur in parallel or post-approval).
4. Receipt of approval or conditional approval with corrective action requests.

The 6-week estimate in Option B assumes standard processing timeline and no significant deficiencies noted during FDA review. Complex equipment or novel sterilization methodologies may extend timelines.

Autoclave Throughput Calculations

The AutoClave Pro 900 specification indicates a rated throughput of 1 unit per 18 minutes, equaling 3.33 units per hour at maximum capacity. However, production bottleneck analysis (referenced in Option B) indicates the upstream line feed rate is mechanically capped at 1.538 units per hour due to materials handling constraints.

In this scenario, the AutoClave Pro 900 would operate significantly below maximum capacity (46% utilization), creating a throughput mismatch. This suggests that capital investment in sterilization equipment alone does not address the root constraint unless accompanying investments are made in upstream processing infrastructure.

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